Policy 4 – Policy Management & Exception Handling

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2. Policy Objectives and Scope

2.1 Purpose – Ensure all governance, security, and privacy policies are current, traceable, and that any deviations are formally approved, time-boxed, and documented.

2.2 Scope – All organisational policies and standards, all personnel, and all systems governed by those documents.

2.3 Policy Inventory & Ownership

- Maintain a master list of active policies, each with a named owner.
- Store the inventory in a shared repository accessible to all personnel.

2.4 Version Control & Distribution

- Keep policies under version control with commit history.
- Include a version number and last-review date in each document.
- Notify personnel of major updates within five business days.

2.5 Scheduled Review Cycle

- Owners review their policies at least once every 12 months.
- Document “Reviewed – no change” or note revisions in the change log.

2.6 Exception Request Process

- Any employee may request an exception by submitting: scope, justification, risk, compensating controls, proposed expiry.
- The policy owner and senior management jointly approve or reject within ten business days.

2.7 Exception Register & Sunset

- Record all approved exceptions in an Exception Register with owner and expiry date.
- Review the register monthly; close or renew any item reaching expiry.

3. Policy Compliance

3.1 Compliance Measurement – Inventory exists; ≥ 90 % of policies show review within 12 months; no exceptions past expiry.

3.2 Exceptions – Handled per 2.6 and logged in the Exception Register.

3.3 Non-Compliance – Missing reviews or unmanaged exceptions escalated to senior management and corrected within 30 days.

3.4 Continual Improvement – Incorporate audit findings and user feedback at the next scheduled review.